



Vanishing trick

Many animals mimic dead leaves and rely on their camouflage as protection against predators, but one particular lizard is a master of this type of disguise. The leaf-tailed gecko lives in the forests of Madagascar and is almost impossible to spot among the dead leaves in the trees and on the forest floor. Its dark body is marked with ribs and veins, while its leaf-shaped tail has notched edges, as if it has been nibbled by caterpillars. The gecko is active at night, feeding on a diet of insects. During the day, it keeps motionless so that it magically disappears from sight.